

A Deadline Is Not a Plan

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Executive Summary

Deadlines alone don't get tasks done. You must also estimate the time a task requires and schedule a dedicated calendar block — defining not just *when it's due*, but *when you'll actually do it*.

Contents

-  The Problem with Deadlines Alone
-  Example: Getting a Gym Membership
-  The Three-Step Framework

The Problem with Deadlines Alone 0:00

- Having a deadline for a one-time task is necessary but insufficient on its own
 - A deadline only tells you *when something should be finished*, not *when you will work on it*
 - The gap between "due date" and "scheduled work time" is where tasks fall through the cracks
- The fix is time-blocking: placing the actual work into your calendar as a reserved slot

Example: Getting a Gym Membership 0:23

- Scenario: one of your goals is to lose 20 lbs, and a required task is signing up for a gym membership
- Breaking down the realistic time estimate for that single errand:
 - ~1 hour to get dressed and travel to the gym
 - ~1 hour to be shown around the gym and complete the sign-up process
 - ~1 hour to travel back home
 - Total estimate: **3 hours**
- That 3-hour block must be placed explicitly in the calendar — not just noted as a deadline

The Three-Step Framework 0:46

- Step 1 — Give the task a deadline
- Step 2 — Estimate how long it will actually take to complete
- Step 3 — Put that time estimate as a blocked slot in your calendar

The key distinction: plan not just *when it's going to get done*, but *when you're going to do it*.